AI Sales Intelligence

Business Applications & Implementation Strategy

Strategy v1.0 • 2 November 2026 • GuestFlow is a fictional hospitality SaaS case study.

Document purpose: Turn the AI Sales Intelligence experiments into a practical, testable operating strategy for GuestFlow prospecting. This version reflects both Experiment A and Experiment B, plus the separately built financial simulator. It distinguishes observed evaluation results from recommendations and hypotheses that still need a controlled pilot.

1. Executive summary

This project examines how structured company research and AI-assisted analysis could support B2B prospecting for GuestFlow, a fictional guest relationship management platform for restaurant operators. In Experiment A, four platforms each applied the supplied ideal customer profile (ICP) rubric to ten UK restaurant brands in one closed-book run; all 40 scores and all 40 priority labels matched the reference. Experiment B then tested independent commercial research: after a single-reviewer audit, saved scores ranged from 31/100 to 73/100, with differences in evidence quality, venue scope and commercial interpretation. These are findings about the tested outputs, not general rankings of model capability.

The recommended application is an auditable assisted workflow: collect and verify evidence, calculate the fixed score with deterministic rules, flag conflicts and strategic exceptions, and use AI only for bounded summaries or research hypotheses that a person can inspect. Experiment A supports rule-following with supplied inputs; Experiment B reinforces the need for source-level checks before using commercial claims.

Recommendation: Use the existing dataset and GuestFlow simulator as planning tools, then run a small, auditable qualification pilot. Measure verified-field accuracy, analyst time, exception handling and sales-team usefulness against a manual baseline before expanding scope or making return claims.

2. Business problem and target users

2.1 Business problem

Sales development representatives (SDRs), business development representatives (BDRs) and revenue operations teams need to identify which organisations warrant attention. Prospect lists can contain incomplete location data, outdated expansion claims, inconsistent brand-versus-parent-group records and little explanation of why a lead is prioritised. Manual assessment is slow; inconsistent approaches can reduce trust in the pipeline.

For GuestFlow, scale and recent expansion are plausible early indicators of potential demand for multi-location guest CRM. However, those indicators are proxies, not evidence of software need, buying intent, budget or the likelihood of a sale.

2.2 Intended users

Primary users: SDR/BDR teams reviewing new accounts; sales operations maintaining scoring policy and CRM fields; sales managers auditing prioritisation; and research analysts verifying source evidence. A commercial lead should own policy decisions and escalation thresholds.

2.3 Business objectives to test

Reduce repetitive manual scoring; standardise classification and explanations; preserve source provenance; flag missing or conflicting information; enable faster sales handoffs; and identify where an initial ICP score needs human commercial review. These are proposed outcomes—not benefits established by Experiment A.

3. Evidence base: what Experiment A supports

3.1 Observed evidence

Four tested platforms: ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini 3 and DeepSeek. Each completed one zero-shot, closed-book evaluation of the same ten UK restaurant brands against prompt A-v1. The score formula and location/expansion inputs were supplied; reference outcomes and broader commercial notes were withheld. All 40 company-level scores and priority decisions matched the reference sheet. The recorded rationales correctly explained the supplied calculations.

3.2 What has not been established

Experiment A did not assess independent web research, externally sourced fact accuracy, willingness to buy GuestFlow, deal value, integration feasibility, CRM adoption, sales productivity or downstream revenue. It used one run per platform, so the result does not establish repeatability. Experiment B did assess independent commercial research, but its one-reviewer audit and saved outputs do not establish general model performance or commercial outcomes.

Model configurations are incompletely documented for some runs; see the Experiment log. Evidence in the project has since clarified that the official Pizza Pilgrims directory listed 30 pizzerias at the 2 November 2026 check, while a July trade report cited 31 and the assessment-date comparison remains imperfectly aligned by date and venue format. The project uses 30 as the current planning count and retains the dated discrepancy. A recorded zero verified additional openings means none were established in the dataset, not that none occurred.

3.3 Implication for implementation

Separate the reliability of applying a rule from the reliability of the underlying business facts. A correct score calculated from an incorrect location count is still a commercially unreliable record. A robust system must check evidence and maintain provenance before scoring.

4. Proposed business applications

Use case A — Consistent, automated lead triage

Inputs: company name, same-brand UK location count, verified additional UK openings and data verification status. Process: a deterministic scoring rule applies the Experiment A brackets and returns the component scores, total and priority. Output: a sortable CRM queue with calculation details and an audit trail. Value hypothesis: lower administrative effort and fewer inconsistent scoring decisions. Human safeguard: hold incomplete or disputed records for review.

Use case B — Evidence extraction and data preparation.

Inputs: official company sites, announcements and reputable industry reporting. A bounded AI extraction step may propose brand names, location counts, opening dates and source passages for validation. A researcher checks each proposed fact and distinguishes an initial opening from an additional opening. Experiment B provides an initial evaluation of independent commercial research, but it was a single-reviewer audit rather than a standardised extraction benchmark. A dedicated test should measure claim-level support, exact source quality, count/date accuracy and uncertainty handling before this use case is operationalised.

Use case C — Explainable SDR handoffs.

An account record can combine verified source facts with a plain-language summary: why the prospect received its score, which assumptions affect confidence and what needs confirming in discovery. The generated narrative must be grounded in stored data, not treated as independent evidence. Reps should be able to inspect the exact rule version, underlying inputs and source links.

Use case D — Strategic-account exception review.w

A low same-brand UK location count can conceal a wider potential opportunity. Carbone London, for example, received 0/100 on the original rubric because it had one UK restaurant and no qualifying additional opening in the assessment window. At the same time, its association with a broader hospitality group suggests a separate strategic-account question. The correct next step is to verify group structure, buyer responsibilities and technology fit—not automatically upgrade the brand's original score.

Other exception categories include premium single-site operators, multi-brand groups, rapidly developing smaller chains and operators with uncertain existing software arrangements. Experiment B should evaluate the quality and evidence discipline of these more nuanced judgements.

5. Recommended operating model

5.1 Workflow

Step 1 — Source and normalise. Record company/brand identifiers, parent group as a separate field, geography, site counts, openings, dates and URLs.

Step 2 — Validate. Check whether sources support the count and whether openings are additional, permanent and within the defined measurement window. Mark disputed or missing claims.

Step 3 — Calculate. Apply fixed ICP rules in a spreadsheet or service; store scoring-rubric version, inputs, component points and classification.

Step 4 — Explain. Optionally generate a source-grounded account summary and suggested discovery questions. Clearly mark AI-generated assessments.

Step 5 — Review exceptions. Send unknown counts, conflicting evidence, low-confidence records and potentially important parent-group opportunities to a human reviewer.

Step 6 — Publish to CRM. Write only approved fields to the sales queue, record reviewer and timestamp, and retain links to source material.

Step 7 — Learn. Capture rep overrides, disqualifications and verified outcomes to improve the data pipeline and eventually assess whether the ICP is commercially predictive.

5.2 Minimum account record

Suggested fields: account ID; brand name; legal or parent group (when verified); UK same-brand locations; verified additional UK openings; window start/end; evidence URLs; source dates; source-confidence status; location points; expansion points; total score; priority; rubric version; AI narrative (optional); exception flag; review owner; last-checked date; and CRM disposition.

5.3 Decision rights

The rules engine owns arithmetic; the evidence reviewer owns factual verification; sales operations owns thresholds and field definitions; the sales representative owns outreach judgement; the commercial manager approves changes to the prioritisation policy. LLM-generated recommendations are advisory until separately validated.

6. Implementation roadmap

Phase 1 — Define and prepare (proposed weeks 1–2)

Freeze the A-v1 rubric and data dictionary. Establish the brand-versus-group distinction, review window and evidence categories. Reconcile known source disagreements. Create a gold-standard test file with edge cases: 1, 2, 4, 5, 9 and 10 locations; 0, 1 and 2 openings; missing fields; first-ever openings; and conflicting sources.

Phase 2 — Build the minimum viable workflow (proposed weeks 3–4)

Implement formulas or scripts for deterministic scoring, input validation, review status and source links. Keep the first version within Google Sheets or a basic CRM sandbox. Add a human-reviewed AI summary only after the numerical and provenance fields are stable. The minimum viable product does not require a fully autonomous agent.

Phase 3 — Evaluate in shadow mode (proposed weeks 5–6)

Run the workflow on a larger, held-out sample without changing real outreach priorities. Compare against independently checked records. Test conflicting data, uncertain brands and model-generated claims. Have at least two reviewers examine a sample of commercial explanations and record disagreements.

Phase 4 — Controlled pilot and decision gate (proposed weeks 7–8)

Give a small sales team access to approved results while retaining human sign-off. Measure time per researched and reviewed account, exception backlog, override rates and usability. Decide whether to proceed, revise the scoring policy, narrow the scope or stop. Timings are planning assumptions, not committed delivery estimates.

7. Success metrics and pilot design

7.1 Operational quality measures

Rule accuracy: exact score/classification agreement on held-out cases; input accuracy: share of fields confirmed against evidence; provenance coverage: share of records with current source links; unsupported-claim rate: number of factual AI assertions lacking support; exception sensitivity: percentage of deliberately ambiguous records sent for review; and correction/override rate after review.

7.2 Efficiency and adoption measures

Track median analyst minutes per account, proportion processed without correction, reviewer workload, turnaround time from source to approved CRM record, rep utilisation and the percentage of suggested accounts that sales staff consider worth investigating. Compare with a manual baseline under similar data conditions.

7.3 Commercial measures—later-stage only

Track meeting acceptance, qualified opportunity conversion, average contract value, sales-cycle length and pipeline influenced by the workflow only after the data and handoff process are stable. Such outcomes are affected by the market, account selection, outreach quality and sales execution; attribution requires a suitable comparison design.

7.4 Proposed acceptance criteria

Before production use, require deterministic scoring tests to pass without errors, independently checked source fields to meet an agreed quality threshold, an explicit review route for all uncertain accounts, and no unaudited AI assertion to enter the CRM as verified fact. Set exact numerical thresholds with the pilot team before testing, rather than choosing them after observing results.

8. Illustrative economics and value assessment

8.1 Time-saving scenario—not an observed result

Assume 1,000 accounts processed per month, a manual baseline of four minutes per account and one minute of automated-workflow review per account. The gross capacity released would be 1,000 × (4 − 1) ÷ 60 = 50 staff-hours per month. At an illustrative fully loaded staff cost of £25/hour, that represents £1,250/month in theoretical capacity value. These are assumptions only: they exclude software fees, data subscriptions, build costs, quality-control overhead, and the fact that saved time does not automatically translate into cash savings or additional revenue.

8.2 Costs and benefits to measure

Implementation costs may include source-data access, spreadsheet/CRM integration, model usage, human validation, monitoring and security review. Benefits might include faster research, improved consistency and better-directed outreach. A pilot business case should use measured time, quality and outcomes rather than relying on the perfect baseline score as proof of positive ROI.

8.3 GuestFlow account value is a separate model

GuestFlow's fictional pricing model in the separate financial simulator is £300/month per group plus £350/month per participating venue, with optional analytics at £150/month per venue and a 2% fee on eligible prepaid transactions. The simulator separates subscription ARR from variable transaction fees and exposes venue adoption, analytics uptake, prepaid volume and timing as assumptions. Account subscription ARR can be calculated as 12 × [£300 + (£350 × participating venues) + (£150 × analytics venues)]. Transaction fees are variable and depend on eligible volume; they are not subscription ARR. These are planning illustrations, not evidence of willingness to pay, booked revenue, forecast probability, profit or acquisition economics.

9. Risks, safeguards and governance

Data quality and freshness

Restaurant openings, closures and ownership changes can make even once-valid counts stale. Include dated sources, expiry/recheck rules and separate statuses for verified, partially

verified and unverified facts. Never equate a missing opening record with evidence that nothing happened.

Overconfident narratives and group confusion

An LLM may turn plausible commercial hypotheses into confident claims. Distinguish verified parent relationships from assumptions about shared budgets or technology procurement. Avoid transferring the location count of a large parent portfolio to a single restaurant brand.

Privacy, consent and access

Keep personal customer data and any confidential CRM information out of external models unless the selected platform and organisational controls permit it. Define permissible data, access controls, retention, consent requirements for marketing-related use cases and a process for reviewing generated outreach content.

Operational reliability

Version prompts and rules; log input sources, calculation outputs and human overrides; provide a fallback when a model fails or gives inconsistent answers; and maintain a clear route for correcting wrong records. Conduct basic cost, latency and error monitoring during any pilot.

10. Recommendations and outstanding decisions

Immediate recommendation: adopt a hybrid design—deterministic scoring for Experiment A-style inputs, evidence validation before scoring, and optional AI-generated explanations with explicit human review. Avoid presenting the result as an autonomous commercial decision-maker.

Next validation priority: test the proposed workflow on a larger held-out account sample using a shared, dated evidence pack, independent verification and at least two reviewers for a subset. Measure factual support, source traceability, venue-scope handling, product fit, uncertainty, analyst time and usefulness to sales. Use the findings report's Experiment B audit as a baseline for designing this test, not as proof the workflow is already effective.

Open decisions for the next revision: Who is the target buyer (single-brand operator, multi-brand hospitality group or both)? What data-source refresh schedule is feasible? Which CRM environment is in scope? What constitutes a meaningful sales-ready lead? What is the minimum acceptable source coverage? Who approves borderline cases? What will the pilot's comparative baseline and budget be?

Status: This is a proposed business implementation strategy, not evidence that GuestFlow exists as a deployed product or that any restaurant group has purchased, piloted or expressed intent to purchase it.

11. Source documents and change log

Evaluation basis: AI Sales Intelligence — Evaluation Findings Report

Underlying records: AI Sales Evaluation Dataset (Human Scores, Experiment log, Experiment A results, Experiment B outputs, and verification tabs)

Version v1.0 (2 November 2026): Revised to incorporate the Experiment B audit, current Pizza Pilgrims count treatment and the completed GuestFlow financial simulator. The operating model, roadmap, pilot economics and expected effects remain proposals or illustrative assumptions until tested in a controlled pilot.